Sophie Sunderland

sophiesunderland.github.io ◇ sunder16@msu.edu

Education

Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI
Political Science, PhD — *2023- present*

- Subfields: Comparative Politics and Political Methodology

Michigan State University — East Lansing, MI
Political Science, MA — *2026*

University of Florida — Gainesville, FL
Political Science, MA — *August 2021-December 2022*

- African Politics minor

University of Florida — Gainesville, FL
Political Science, BA — *August 2019-May 2021*

- Latin American Politics minor

Publications

Editor-Reviewed

1. **Sunderland, Sophie** and Michael Wahman. *Protecting Turf or Expanding the Map? The Political Geography of African Parliamentary Campaign Spending.* In The New Ground Wars: Changing Ground Campaigns in Africa (eds). Forthcoming.

2. **Sunderland, Sophie**, 2023. Review of *Parties, political finance, and governance in Africa: extracting money and shaping states in Benin and Ghana*. By Rachel Sigman. *Democratization*, 31, 2.

Working Papers

1. Lindsay Favero and **Sophie Sunderland**. *Everyday Authoritarian Control: Regime Presence in Electoral Autocracies*

2. Lindsay Favero, Nicholas Kerr, **Sophie Sunderland** and Michael Wahman. *Pushing the Boundaries: Boundary Delimitation and Perceptions of Legislative Representation*

3. **Sophie Sunderland**. *Responsive in Whose Eyes? Electoral Competition and Perceptions of Responsiveness*

Research Experience

Afrobarometer — Fall 2023-present
Research Assistant, Data Analysis Unit
Published analyses linked here

Experiential Learning and Fieldwork Lab — Fall 2026
Research Assistant for Dr. Ana Bracic

Teaching Experience

Instructor

- African Politics — Spring 2027

Co-instructor

- Evaluating Evidence — Summer 2026
- Pandemics and Social Science — Summer 2025
- Intro to Comparative Politics — Summer 2024
- Programming in R for PhD Students Summer Course — Summer 2024

Teaching Assistant

- Intro to Comparative Politics — Fall 2025
- Intro to American Politics — Fall 2022

Conference and Workshop Presentations

African Studies Association — 2025, 2026
American Political Science Association — 2025, 2026
Political Parties in Africa — 2026

Service

Political Science Department Graduate Student Association President — 2025-present
Graduate Dean's Student Advisory Committee Representative — 2025-present
Graduate School Hearing Board, PLS Representative — 2024-27
MSU Comparative Politics and International Relations Workshop Series, Co-organizer — 2024-25

Grants & Fellowships

MSU Political Science Department Research Grant (2024) — $2,000
MSU Political Science Department Research Grant (2026) — $5,000
MSU Graduate School Research Grant — $6,000
MSU African Studies Center Graduate Research Development Fellowship — $2,000
Gliozzo Overseas Research Dissertation Scholarship — $3,600
Humane Studies Fellowship — $500

Skills

Technical: LaTeX, **R**, Python, Stata, SPSS

Fieldwork

Angola — 2025
Zambia — 2026